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California Assembly - Scramble is on for seats in statehouse

June 8, 2022 | San Gabriel Valley Tribune (West Covina, CA)
Author: From staff report | Section: News | 556 Words
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OpenURL Link

Even longtime politics watchers may need a scorecard to follow this year's state Assembly races in districts that touch Los Angeles County, with redistricting delivering new numbers, rejiggered footprints and some entirely new districts. Here's how Tuesday's primary elections played out in early returns:

District 34 >> In the High Desert,two incumbents — Assembly members Tom Lackey, R-Palmdale, and Thurston "Smitty" Smith, R-Apple Valley — were running. Also on the ballot: Republican Paul Fournier, Democrats Raj Kahlon and Rita Ramirez Dean, and Independent Roger LaPlante.Lackey and Dean took the early lead.

District 39 >> Democrat Steve Foxfaces fellow Democrats Juan Carrillo, a Palmdale City Council member, and Andrea Rosenthal, former political director. Also running: Republican Paul Marsh, a community services liaison.Carrillo and Marsh took the early lead.

District 40 >>GOP incumbent Suzette Martinez Valladares faces Democrats Annie Cho, a businesswoman, and nurse practitioner Pilar Schiavo. Martinez Valladares and Schiavo took the early lead.

District 41 >>Five-term incumbent Democrat Chris Holden was unopposed.

District 42 >> Democratic Assemblywoman Jacqui Irwin faces GOP newcomers Lori Mills and Ted Nordblum. Irwin took the early lead.

District 43 >> In this San Fernando Valley district, no one is opposing Assemblywoman Luz Maria Rivas.

District 44 >> In this Burbank-area district,two-term Democratic Assemblywoman Laura Friedmanfaces Republican business owner Barry Jacobsen. Friedman led early.

District 46 >> Democratic Assemblyman Jesse Gabriel faces Republican Dana Caruso. Gabriel led early.

District 48 >> Incumbent Democrat Blanca Rubio was unopposed.

District 49 >> It's a rematch. Back in February, Democrat Mike Fong defeated Republican Burton Brink in a special election.Fong led early.

District 51 >>Democrat newcomers Louis Abramson, a scientist, and Rick Chavez Zbur, a civil rights attorney who led early, square off.

District 52 >> Democratic Assemblywoman Wendy Carrillo, who led early, raced againstDemocrat Mia Livas Porter, in second early on, and Republican Gia D'Amato.

District 53 >> Democratic Assemblyman Freddie Rodriguez, who led early, battled Republican Toni Holle, whom he defeated in 2018 and 2020.

District 54 >>Incumbent Democrat Miguel Santiago is unopposed.

District 55 >>Democratic Assemblyman Isaac Bryan won a special election last year in District 54. Bryan ledover GOP newcomer Keith Cascio.

District 56 >> Democratic Assemblywoman Lisa Calderonfaces Republicans Jessica Martinezand Natasha Serrano. Calderon jumped in front, followed by Martinez.

District 57 >>Democratic Assemblyman Reginald Jones-Sawyer is unopposed.

District 61 >>Lawndale Mayor Robert Pullen-Miles and Democrat Tina Simon McKinnor, a non-profit director, face one another in a runoff to serve out only the short remainder of Autumn Burke's term, until Dec. 4. ConcurrentlyPullen-Miles, McKinnor, andthree others are running to serve in the new 61st District for a full two years. Pullen-Miles and McKinnor jumped in front early.

District 62 >> Democrat incumbent Assemblyman Anthony Rendonhas defeated his opponent, fellow Democrat Maria Estrada, twice before.Rendon led early.

District 64 >>Republican Raul Ortiz Jr. takes on an array of Democrats includingBlanca Pacheco,Elizabeth Alcantar,Roberto Cancio,Rose Espinoza andAna Valencia. Pacheco and Ortiz led early.

District 65 >>Democratic Assemblyman Mike Gipson, who led early,takes on Dubai-born Fatima Iqbal-Zubair.

District 66 >> Three-term Democratic incumbent Al Muratsuchiled early against Republican George Barks.

District 67 >>Sharon Quirk-Silva faces a challenge from fellow Democrat Paramvir "Param" Brar, as well as Republicans Soo Yooand Sou Moua. Quirk-Silva and Yoo jumped in front early.

District 69 >>Long Beach Councilman Al Austin and businessman Josh Lowenthalface county Democratic Central Committee member Janet Foster and nurse practitioner Merry Taheri. Lowenthal jumped in front.

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- **Citation (apa Style)**
  staff report, F. (2022, June 8). California Assembly Scramble is on for seats in statehouse*San Gabriel Valley Tribune (West Covina, CA)*, p. 5. Available from NewsBank: Access World News – Historical and Current: https://infoweb.newsbank.com/apps/news/document-view?p=WORLDNEWS&docref=news/18A81CD3571C5DD8.